

Key Outcomes

The team received guidance to refine their novelty statement from a feature-comparison approach to a customer-problem-focused statement emphasizing **spontaneous event access and cost savings**. The dual-platform strategy (mobile for students, web for venues) was approved, and the team must conduct more user interviews, add a Gantt chart to the timeline, and incorporate requirements analysis into the budget.

Decisions Made

- **Platform split confirmed:** Mobile app targets students; web app serves venue dashboard for posting last-minute slots
- **Novelty statement core:** Focus on "saving money for spontaneous events" rather than listing features
- **Machine learning approach:** Use predictive models for busyness/popularity estimation rather than only real-time API calls; minimum 2 datasets required
- **Data strategy:** Leverage Ticketmaster and Eventbrite APIs; synthetic data only as last resort
- **EDI integration:** Must be incorporated from the start, not as an afterthought

Feedback on Deliverables

Business Plan

- **Budget structure praised:** Activity-based allocation totaling €24,000 is well-estimated and "spot on"
- **Risk analysis solid:** Includes likelihood and mitigation strategies; should add severity dimension
- **Missing elements:**
 - Requirements analysis section absent from budget breakdown
 - Gantt chart needed with actual time allocations within sprints, not vague descriptions
 - Feature comparison table recommended (apps vs. features matrix with checkmarks)

Literature Review

- **Strengths:** Good critical reflection beyond summarization; identified limitations both from paper and independent analysis
- **Improvements needed:**
 - Add explicit references with authors and paper titles
 - Extract positive aspects and techniques (ML methods, data analysis approaches) that can be recycled into the project
 - Include visual aids where applicable

Novelty Statement

- **Current issue:** Too feature-focused and competitor-comparison heavy; reads like business plan content rather than a customer-facing statement

- **Required approach:** Answer "How do I reach this goal now vs. with your app?" in 2-3 concrete sentences for someone unfamiliar with alternatives
- **Core message:** Address the problem of limited spontaneous options in saturated cities like Dublin/Manhattan where everything books months ahead

Pending Confirmation

- **Team contract:** Not uploaded; must be sent via email with detailed violation consequences
- **EDI element specification:** Needs better focus and early-stage integration plan
- **Feature prioritization:** Team must determine feature scope through user validation, not instructor approval

Technical Guidance

Machine Learning Requirements

- Predict **busyness in areas** using available datasets (e.g., crowd density proxies)
- Estimate **event popularity in advance** based on target audience, typical fans, location proximity
- Consider context: High/low/medium ranges must account for venue size (100 people in stadium = empty)
- Focus on **meaningfulness over quantity** of features; minimum 2 datasets mandatory

Data Strategy

- Prioritize **inferring needed data** from proxy datasets over synthetic generation
- For last-minute availability: predict likelihood of events with available tickets in user's vicinity (avoid 2-hour travel scenarios)
- Use multiple data layers for more accurate predictions when feasible

Action Items

- **Team:** Rewrite novelty statement to 2-3 sentences focusing on customer problem (spontaneous event access + cost savings)
- **Team:** Conduct extensive user interviews with diverse students; document and summarize using generative AI
- **Team:** Add Gantt chart with detailed sprint timelines to business plan
- **Team:** Insert requirements analysis section into budget breakdown
- **Team:** Create feature comparison matrix table for competitive analysis
- **Team:** Email team contract with detailed violation consequences to Alessio
- **Team:** Add explicit references (authors, titles) to literature review
- **Team:** Implement incremental user feedback loops (interviews at mockup, prototype, and sprint review stages)
- **Team:** Define predictive ML features focusing on busyness estimation and event popularity

User Research Strategy

- **Target accessibility:** All team members' friends are potential users—leverage this for initial and incremental feedback

- **Interview cadence:** Conduct interviews at mockup stage, prototype stage, and during sprint reviews with mock customers
- **Validation approach:** Let users determine feature priority and usefulness, not the instructor

Next Steps

- Submit revised materials incorporating feedback before Friday meeting
- Prioritize bare-bones app development (listings + booking), then layer features based on user validation